

IK 525: Advanced Vedanta Philosophy

Course Code	IK 525
Course Name	Advanced Vedanta Philosophy
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	IK 536: Introduction to Vedanta Philosophy or IKS 541: Upanisads and Vedanta Studies or an equivalent understanding of Indian Philosophy
Intended for	B.Tech/MTech/MS/MSc/MA/PhD
Mutual Exclusion	None
Approval	64th BoA (May 2026)

Preamble

This course is an advanced and comprehensive study of Vedānta Philosophy designed in close alignment with the Indian Philosophical Systems component of the official UGC NET Indian Knowledge System (IKS) Code 103 syllabus. The course particularly focuses on Uttaramīmāṃsā (Vedānta), Tarkaśāstra, Pramāṇa theory, Bhagavadgītā, Dharma traditions, Brahmasūtra interpretation traditions, comparative Vedānta schools, liberation theories, and Vedāntic hermeneutics.

Building upon the foundational course “Introduction to Vedanta Philosophy,” the present course systematically introduces the major Vedānta schools including Advaita, Viśiṣṭādvaita, Dvaita, Bhedābheda, Śuddhādvaita, Śiva-Viśiṣṭādvaita, Avibhāgādvaita, and Acintyābheda traditions. The course emphasizes Brahman, Jīva, Mokṣa, epistemology, causation, Bhakti, liberation theories, and the interpretation traditions of the Brahmasūtras and Upaniṣads.

The course is specially structured for advanced understanding of Vedānta philosophy, comparative analysis of Vedānta traditions, UGC NET/JRF (Code 103) preparation, conceptual clarity in Indian philosophical systems, and research-oriented engagement with Vedāntic literature and traditions.

Course Modules

- Module 1: Foundations of Vedānta and Indian Philosophical Systems:** Meaning, scope, and distinct characteristics of Vedānta, Vedānta as Uttaramīmāṃsā and word-rooted philosophy, Prasthānatrayī, concepts of Brahman, Ātman, Jīva, Jagat, and Mokṣa, Caturdaśa Vidyāsthānas, āstika and nāstika darśanas, overview of Nyāya, Sāṅkhya, Yoga, Pūrvamīmāṃsā, and Vedānta systems, Dharma–Artha–Kāma–Mokṣa framework, and introduction to Vedāntic literature. (6 Hours)
- Module 2: Tarkaśāstra, Pramāṇa Theory and Vedāntic Hermeneutics:** Pramāṇa theory including Pratyakṣa, Anumāna, Upamāna, Śabda, Arthāpatti, and Anupalabdhi, concepts of Pramātā, Pramāṇa, Prameya, Pramā, Svataḥprāmāṇya, and Parataḥprāmāṇya, powers of words including Abhidhā, Lakṣaṇā, Vyañjanā, and Tātparya, Mahāvākyas, Catuḥsūtrī, Pañcādhi-karaṇa system, Pūrvapakṣa–Uttarapakṣa methodology, role of Tarka in Vedānta, and Mīmāṃsā–Śāstrabheda traditions. (6 Hours)
- Module 3: Śāṅkarācārya’s Kevalādvaitavāda:** Advaita literature, Adhyāsa theory, Saviśeṣa and Nirguṇa Brahman, Vedic knowledge of Brahman, Jīva–Brahman relationship, Jīvanmukti, nature of liberation, Śāṅkara’s interpretation of Brahmasūtra and Catuḥsūtrī, interpretation of Bheda Śrutis, refutation of opponent schools, and Śāṅkara’s philosophical understanding of the world. (6 Hours)

- **Module 4: Viśiṣṭādvaita, Svābhāvika-Bhedābheda and Dvaita Traditions:** Bhāskara's Bhinnābhinnarūpa-Brahmavāda, Jñāna-karma-samuccayavāda, Jīva–Brahman relation, Brahman and world, liberation, meaning of the Vedas, Rāmānuja's Viśiṣṭādvaita literature, interpretation of Catuḥsūtrī, Bhakti and Śaraṇāgati, Pramāṇa theory, Pāñcarātra doctrines, critique of Advaita and Jīvanmukti, Nimbārka's Svābhāvika-bhedābheda doctrine, Madhvācārya's Dvaita philosophy, interpretation of Śrutis and Vedāntic principles, and theories of liberation across these traditions. (6 Hours)
- **Module 5: Śaiva, Śuddhādvaita, Acintyābheda and AkṣarPuruṣottama Darshan Traditions:** Śrīkaṇṭha's Śiva-Viśiṣṭādvaita, Śiva principle, Jīva principle, Vidyā and liberation, interpretation of Catuḥsūtrī, Śrīpati's Viśeṣādvaita and Vīra-Śaivism, Vedābhāṣya systems, Jīva–Brahman relation, Vallabhācārya's Śuddhādvaita, Bhaktirasa, Puruṣottamavāda, Mokṣa and epistemology, Vijñānabhikṣu's Avibhāgādvaita, critique of Śāṅkara, Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa's Acintyābheda, Caitanya tradition, AkṣarPuruṣottama Darshan and liberation doctrines in later Vedāntic systems. (6 Hours)
- **Module 6: Comparative Review of Vedānta Schools and Scriptural Traditions:** Comparative review of Vedānta schools, doctrine of Brahman, Brahman as the highest goal of life, refutation of anti-Vedic systems, Purāṇic Vedānta traditions, Śaiva schools, Tantra and Vedānta traditions, status of the Vedas in Tantric literature, Bhagavadgītā as a Vedāntic text, and Daivī–Āsurī Sampat of Bhagavadgītā Chapter 16. (6 Hours)
- **Module 7: Vedānta and Contemporary Intellectual Discourses:** Vedānta and consciousness studies, Vedānta and psychology, Vedānta and wellbeing, Vedānta and contemporary philosophy, Vedānta and cognitive sciences, interdisciplinary relevance of Vedānta, Vedānta in dialogue with global intellectual traditions, and contemporary applications of Vedāntic thought in modern academic and philosophical discourse. (6 Hours)

Text Books

1. Radhakrishnan, S. *Indian Philosophy*, Vol. I & II, Oxford University Press.
2. Sharma, Chandradhar. *A Critical Survey of Indian Philosophy*, Motilal Banarsidass.

References

1. Rāmānujācārya. *Śrībhāṣya*.
2. Madhvācārya. *Anuvyākhyāna*.
3. Vallabhācārya. *Anubhāṣya*.
4. Nimbārka. *Vedānta Pārijāta Saurabha*.
5. Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa. *Govinda Bhāṣya*.
6. Deutsch, Eliot. *Advaita Vedanta*.
7. Clooney, Francis X. *Vedanta Theology*.
8. Dasgupta, Surendranath. *A History of Indian Philosophy*, Vol. I, Cambridge University Press.
9. Swami Gambhirananda. *Brahma Sutra Bhashya of Adi Shankaracharya*, Advaita Ashrama.
10. *Bhagavadgītā* with classical commentaries.
11. Bhadrashdas Swami. *Swaminarayan Bhashyam*, Swaminarayan Aksharpith.